

Vinay Koshy

Website: vinyoshy2.github.io
Email: vkoshy@cs.washington.edu

Research Interests

I work at the intersection of Human-Computer Interaction and Natural Language Processing. I am primarily interested in thinking about the role of *discretion* in human-AI collaboration. Humans often give AI systems tasks to complete that are only partially defined; I design and evaluate systems that can handle task ambiguity, with a focus on human autonomy and growth. I also have a secondary interest in computational social science. In this work, I develop NLP-based approaches to measuring and modeling social phenomena, usually in the context of social dynamics in online communities.

Current Positions

- 2026- **Lecturer**, University of Washington
Course: Data Visualization
- 2025- **Postdoctoral Researcher**, University of Washington
Advisor: Amy Zhang

Education

- 2019-2025 **PhD in Computer Science**, University of Illinois - Urbana-Champaign
Thesis: Computational Approaches for Democratizing Online Community Governance
Advisor: Karrie Karahalios
- 2015-2019 **BA in Computer Science**, University of California - Berkeley
Research Mentors: Gireeja Ranade, Eric Friedman

Publications

- 2025 Venire: A Machine Learning-Guided Panel Review System for Community Content Moderation.
Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)
Vinay Koshy, Frederick Choi, Yi-Shyuan Chiang, Hari Sundaram, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Karrie Karahalios.
- 2025 Organize, Then Vote: Exploring Cognitive Load in Quadratic Survey Interfaces
Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
Ti-Chung Cheng, Yutong Zhang, Yi-Hung Chou, Vinay Koshy, Tiffany Wenting Li, Karrie Karahalios, Hari Sundaram.
- 2025 Placebo Effects of Control Settings Are Not Always Strong
Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
Silas Hsu, Vinay Koshy, Kristen Vaccaro, Christian Sandvig, Karrie Karahalios.
🏆 Best Paper Award
- 2025 Creator Hearts: Investigating the Impact of Positive Signals from YouTube Creators in Shaping Comment Section Behaviors
Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
Frederick Choi, Charlotte Lambert, Vinay Koshy, Sowmya Pratipati, Tue Do, Eshwar Chandrasekharan

- 2024 Not What it Used to Be: Characterizing Content and User-base Changes in Newly Created Online Communities
Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
Alex Atcheson^{*†}, Vinay Koshy^{*}, Karrie Karahalios
🏆 Best Paper Honorable Mention Award
- 2023 Measuring User-Moderator Alignment on r/ChangeMyView
Computer-Supported Cooperative Work (CSCW)
Vinay Koshy, Tanvi Bajpai, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Hari Sundaram, Karrie Karahalios
🏆 Best Paper Award
- 2023 A User-Centric Evaluation of Smart Home Resolution Approaches for Conflicts Between Routines.
Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies (IMWUT)
Ali Zaidi, Rui Yang, Vinay Koshy, Camille Cobb, Indranil Gupta, Karrie Karahalios
- 2021 “We Just Use What They Give Us”: Understanding Passenger User Perspectives in Smart Homes
Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
Vinay Koshy, Joon Sung Park, Ti-Chung Cheng, Karrie Karahalios
🏆 Best Paper Honorable Mention Award

Posters, Extended Abstracts, and Non-Archival Work

- 2026 Modeling Group Socialization in Online Communities
International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2)
Iris Zhong^{*†}, Vinay Koshy^{*}, Karrie Karahalios, Benjamin Mako Hill, Amy Zhang
- 2026 Are News Feeds like Traffic Lights? Surveying Folk Theories of Algorithmic Technologies Beyond Social Media
Annual Conference of the International Communication Association (ICA)
Bhavana Bheem, Sophia Yonus, Vinay Koshy, Motahhare Eslami, Kristen Vaccaro, Karrie Karahalios, Silas Hsu, Christian Sandvig
- 2026 Leveraging Legal Case-Based Reasoning for Accountable AI Governance
ACM Symposium on Computer Science & Law (CSLaw)
Quan Ze (Jim) Chen, Vinay Koshy, K. J. Kevin Feng, Matthew Bilik, Nicholas Caputo, Max Kleiman-Weiner, Amy X. Zhang

Teaching Experience

- 2026 Data Visualization (Instructor of Record)
University of Washington
- 2025 Discrete Structures (TA)
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Under Naina Balepur and Margaret Fleck
- 2021 Social Spaces on the Internet (TA)
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
Under Karrie Karahalios
- 2019 Efficient Algorithms and Intractable Problems (Head TA)
University of California at Berkeley

† denotes mentored student, * denotes equal contribution

- Under Prasad Raghavendra and Luca Trevisan*
- 2018 Efficient Algorithms and Intractable Problems (Head TA)
University of California at Berkeley
Under Alessandro Chiesa and Satish Rao
- 2018 Efficient Algorithms and Intractable Problems (TA)
University of California at Berkeley
Under Umesh Vazirani and Alessandro Chiesa
- 2017 Discrete Mathematics and Probability Theory (TA)
University of California at Berkeley
Under Allen Tang, Hongling Lu, and Vrettos Moulos

Mentoring

- 2026 Kaz Nam (Undergraduate)
Studying rule changes in online communities
- 2026 Nakul Rajpal (Undergraduate)
Building tools to promote healthier disagreements in online discussion
- 2025 Tony Zhou (Undergraduate)
Building LLM agents that can defer to human judgment
- 2025 Matthew Bilik (Junior PhD Student)
Developing case-based approaches to constitutional AI alignment
- 2025 Iris Zhong (Undergraduate)
Coauthored IC2S2 poster and ICWSM full paper submission on modeling socialization processes in online communities
- 2024 Janvi Gandhi (Undergraduate)
Conducted exploratory analysis on inter-subreddit linking events on Reddit
- 2023 Alex Atcheson (Junior PhD Student)
Coauthored CHI Honorable Mention Award winning paper on online community evolution

Invited Talks and Guest Lectures

- 2026 CS 4230: Social Computing
Cal Poly Pomona
- 2025 Data-Driven Approaches to Democratizing Online Community Governance
Behavioral Data Science Lab - University of Washington
Social Futures Lab - University of Washington
University of Iowa
University of Nebraska - Lincoln
Bowdoin College
- 2024 CS498: Computational Social Science
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
- 2023 Rising Stars in Social Computing Seminar
University of Iowa
- 2023 CS567: Social Spaces on the Internet
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign
- 2022 CS498: Antisocial Computing
University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Honors, Awards, and Grants

- 2025 eScience Institute Data Science Postdoctoral Fellow (\$2000 Award)
- 2025 CHI Best Paper Award (Top 1% of Submissions)
- 2024 CHI Student Volunteer Accessibility Award (1 of 2 Awardees)
- 2024 CHI Best Paper Honorable Mention (Top 5% of Submissions)
- 2023 CSCW Best Paper Award (Top 1% of Submissions)
- 2021 UIUC Graduate College Travel Award (1 of 5 Dept. Awardees)
- 2021 CHI Best Paper Honorable Mention (Top 5% of Submissions)

Academic Service

- 2026 IC2S2, CSCW, UIST, ICWSM Reviewer (1 Review Recognition)
- 2025 CSCW Reviewer, CHI Associate Chair (3 Review Recognitions)
- 2024 CHI Accessibility Student Volunteer
- 2024 TiiS, NordiCHI, CSCW, CHI Reviewer (1 Review Recognition)
- 2023 CSCW, CHI Reviewer
- 2022 CSCW, CHI Reviewer
- 2021 Just Infrastructures Speaker Series Organizer
- 2017 Volunteer Computer Science Tutor - Discrete Mathematics

Industry Experience

- 2019 Infrastructure Software Engineer Intern
Salesforce, Service Cloud Performance Engineering Team
- 2018 Infrastructure Software Engineer Intern
Salesforce, APP SCALE Team